admiration for him also stemmed from their knowledge that when Shlomo spoke about a target he was speaking about a place that he had personally experienced.

"Trees die standing tall," as the song goes. We have lost, within a short time of each other, two of the unit's greatest commanders, Shlomo and Kokla. Both of them were killed by the same cursed disease. The metaphor expressed in the song expresses the battle they both waged against the disease. They commanded their units until their final breath. This has been a great loss to the Mossad. May their souls be bound up in the bond of eternal life.

Remarks in Honor of Yitzhak Shamir's Ninety-Fifth Birthday

Dear family members, ministers, members of the Knesset, and comrades in arms from the period before the state was founded, and from the political struggles in the period following the establishment of the state:[1]

This evening is different from others, in that the guest of honor is with us in spirit but not in body. There is both joy and sadness in this. I searched the scriptures for a suitable blessing but came up empty. Nevertheless, Groucho Marx said that "anyone can get old. All you have to do is live long enough." There is no doubt that Yitzhak did this with the same determination with which he did everything throughout his drama-filled life.

And here is a passage from a poem by Leah Goldberg:

> Now with the days, you have whitened and aged
> your days numbered and tenfold dearer,
> and you know: Every day is the last under the sun,
> and you know: Every day is new under the sun.

How much wisdom these four lines contain! This evening seemed to be an appropriate event in which to recite them.

I worked with Prime Minister Shamir for three and a half intensive years, and we developed a close relationship despite our large age gap. On his ninety-fifth birthday, and the eve of my seventy-first, it is only natural to reminisce about the memories that we shared, and some that we didn't share, which I cherish and will continue to cherish all my life.